

Governator hack investigated

Governator hack investigated - mike_barton, InfoWorld.

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by [Mike Barton](#)

Editor

Governator hack investigated

news

Sep 11, 2006 1 min

California Highway Patrol officials have opened a criminal investigation into a number of hacks into Governor Arnold Schwarzenegger's office computers, reports the [San Francisco Chronicle](#).

It comes after an embarrassing private taped conversation, in which Schwarzenegger referred to Latinos and African Americans as having "hot" blood or a passionate temperament, [was leaked last week to the Los Angeles Times](#).

From the Chron report:

"...there was immediate suspicion the tapes were obtained by someone hacking into the computers in the governor's office, where the tapes were stored digitally."

Some experts said government computer systems are among the most vulnerable to outside hackers — especially some systems used by California state agencies that are well known as antiquated.

"Government systems are penetrated on a regular basis," said Bev Harris, executive director of Black Box Voting, a Seattle-based group concerned about electronic voting and hacking.

Is this any surprise, when the federal government is failing in cybersecurity five years after 9/11?

Talk back to us.

Technology Industry

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by Mike Barton

Editor

Mike Barton started out in online slinging HTML for CNET.com in the late 1990s and began his editorial career at New Media magazine shortly thereafter. In his early days, he was an editor at Ziff-Davis's PC Computing and ZDNet.com before heading Down Under, where he produced and edited the business and technology sections of The Sydney Morning Herald online. After returning to the States in 2006, he has worked for IDG's Infoworld, PCWorld, Computerworld, and CSO Online. He currently edits and produces WIRED.com's Innovation Insights, and is a contributing editor at ITworld.

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